No ring to Miami in my early 20's

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📋 Executive Summary

Tim Luong recounts moving to Miami at 25 with fresh money, hitting upscale venues, and discovering that young entrepreneurs compete for attention against elite athletes and billionaires — a humbling "ranked lobby" lesson.

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🏙️ Arriving in Miami: The Ranked Lobby Analogy 0:00

- Tim describes the experience of first moving to Miami as being "thrown into a ranked lobby" as a level-one player
  - The analogy frames Miami's social scene as a highly competitive, tiered environment where status and resources determine your standing
- He moved during COVID alongside a few friends, all making the jump together

🍽️ The Cipriani Dinner Reality Check 0:00

- The group went to dinner at Cipriani, described as "fantastic"
  - Cipriani attracted beautiful women on Friday and Saturday nights
  - This was the first time Tim and his friends had ever encountered or spoken to an actual model
- Context on where they were financially at the time:
  - All approximately **25 years old**
  - Had started their companies a few years prior
  - Had recently come into "new money" — described as "nothing crazy"
    - Just enough to buy bottles at clubs, attend nice dinners, and participate in that lifestyle

📊 The Competition: Who's Actually in the Dating Pool 0:22

- The sobering discovery: the same model they were excited to meet also had far more powerful men in her DMs simultaneously
  - An NFL player
  - An NBA player
  - Likely a billionaire
- This revealed that young, early-career guys are competing in the **same dating pool** as men who are:
  - In their 30s
  - Officially "made it" in their careers
  - Have significant clout and public profile
  - Possess substantially more money and status

🎓 The Hard Lesson Learned 0:44

- Tim and his friends had to learn "the hard way" that there are levels to this social environment
- Key takeaway directed at people early in their careers:
  - Understand that Miami (and similar cities) is a genuinely competitive landscape
  - When you talk to someone attractive there, you are likely "talking to a daddy" — someone already at the top
  - You are "competing in a ranked lobby" against people with far more resources and status

    > "If you are early on your career, just know that it's going to be a competition."

- The implicit advice: temper expectations and recognize where you stand before assuming you can compete at the highest social tiers right away